



Department of Economics
Johns Hopkins University
Baltimore, MD 21218
dedwar65@jh.edu

November 22, 2025

Hiring Committee
Secretariat
1901 L Street NW, Suite 400
Washington, DC 20036

Dear Hiring Committee,

I am writing to express my interest in the Associate position within Secretariat's Antitrust practice. I am a Ph.D. candidate in the Department of Economics at Johns Hopkins University (advisors: Christopher D. Carroll, Nicholas W. Papageorge, and Stelios Fourakis), and I expect to receive my degree in May 2026. My primary specializations are macroeconomic modeling, wealth and income dynamics, and computational economics.

My research agenda focuses on the ability of macroeconomic models to generate empirically realistic distributions of wealth and income over the life cycle. A key driver of that work is modeling heterogeneity in the rate of return on assets, and understanding how return dispersion contributes to portfolio accumulation across households. These themes align closely with Secretariat's emphasis on rigorous empirical analysis, clear reasoning, and transparent modeling—core elements of effective economic testimony in antitrust and competition matters.

In my job-market paper, I calibrate a life-cycle heterogeneous-agent model to match wealth moments from the Survey of Consumer Finances by allowing households to differ in their portfolio returns. The model helps explain observed wealth concentration and return dispersion. In a related research project using the Health and Retirement Study, I examine how trust influences both income growth and asset returns—finding a hump-shaped relationship for returns and characterizing the distribution of the persistent component of returns to net worth. These experiences have equipped me to: (i) frame research strategies and design modeling approaches; (ii) execute econometric and simulation analysis with large micro-data sets; and (iii) translate results into clear, rigorous written deliverables for both academic and practitioner audiences.

I am excited about Secretariat's reputation for clarity, credibility, and analytical excellence in antitrust investigations, merger reviews, and litigation. My quantitative toolkit (Python, Stata), experience assembling and analyzing complex datasets, and ability to construct transparent economic and econometric models make me well-suited for casework involving competitive effects, damages estimation, class certification, and market performance. I am particularly motivated by Secretariat's collaborative culture, its commitment to high-stakes problem-solving, and its emphasis on producing expert work that is both analytically rigorous and clearly communicated to legal audiences.

I believe I would be a strong fit at Secretariat because:

1. My experience with simulation-based modeling, structural estimation, and empirical validation aligns directly with the rigorous quantitative work required in antitrust and competition

analysis.

2. My research on heterogeneity in economic outcomes prepares me to analyze market behavior, assess competitive dynamics, and interpret firm and consumer data in litigation and regulatory contexts.
3. I bring strong communication skills and a collaborative mindset—qualities essential for producing clear written analyses, supporting expert testimony, and working effectively across interdisciplinary teams.

I would welcome the opportunity to contribute my analytical rigor, empirical modeling experience, and dedication to high-quality work to Secretariat's Antitrust practice. Thank you for considering my application.

Sincerely,

Decory Edwards